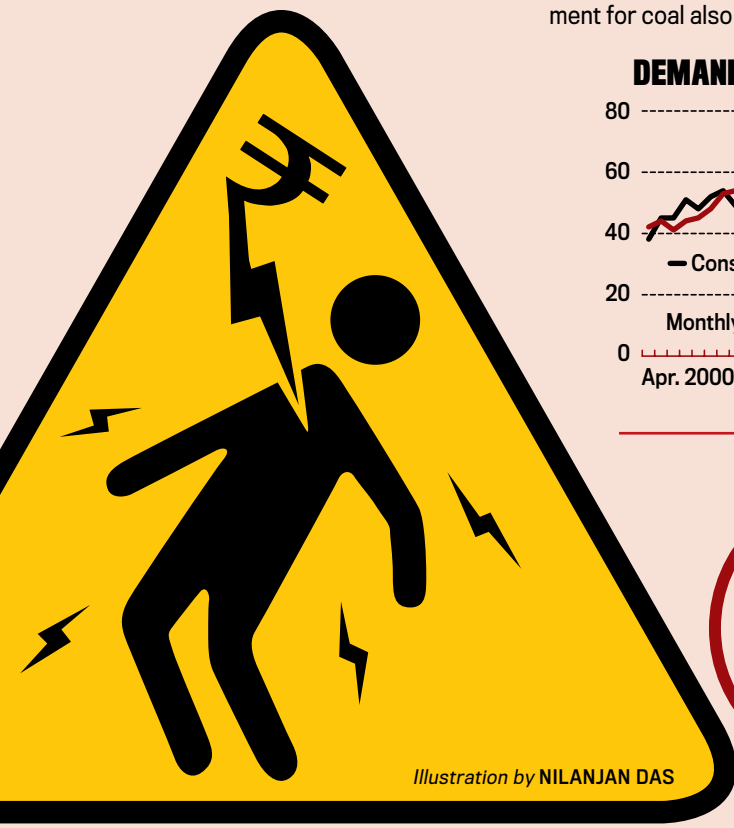
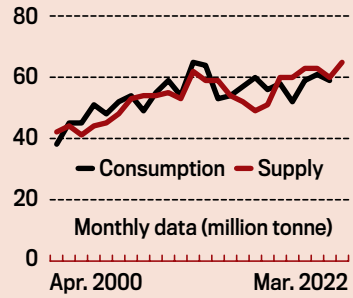


COAL INDIA: THE DARK SIDE

- Coal production by Coal India was sufficient to meet demand. But Indian Railways did not have adequate rakes to transport the coal to gencos on time even as the demand for power peaked.
- Gencos' failure to make timely payment for coal also led to delay in delivery

DEMAND-SUPPLY GAP



453
RAKES/ DAY
Required for adequate coal supply to the 155 thermal plants



379
RAKES/ DAY
What the Railways managed in April, leading to a critical shortage of coal



₹12,272
CRORE
OUTSTANDING DUES OF GENCOS TO COAL INDIA

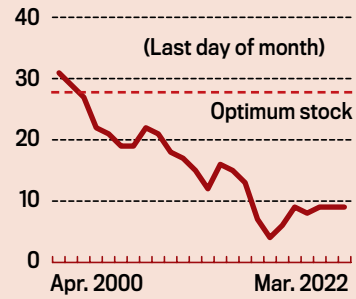
59
PER CENT
Plant load factor for thermal plants in 2021-22

86
of the 155 thermal power plants using domestic coal are critically short of supply

GENCOS: OPERATING BELOW PAR

- The paradox is that even though electricity demand peaked to 207 GW in April, our gencos have an installed capacity of 399 MW–25 per cent more than what was needed
- But the shortage exists because of heavy dependence on thermal power, which accounts for 77 per cent of the supply
- With imported coal prices soaring and not enough domestic coal supplies, thermal power plants are operating at half their load factor, leading to shortage of power supply
- The huge dues owed to them by discoms messes up gencos' finances, including timely purchase of coal

COAL STOCK (DAYS)



249
PER CENT
RISE IN AUSTRALIAN THERMAL COAL PRICE. IT TRADED AT $326.35 A TONNE THIS MONTH, COMPARED TO $93.5 A YEAR AGO



5
POWER PLANTS
out of a total of 15 running on imported coal fell idle because of the skyrocketing fuel prices in the international market, affecting 4 GW of the total 17.25 GW capacity. Rest 10 are running at a fourth of their capacity.

Source: Power Ministry; Crisil Research